

Lecture 8

Giving and Receiving Critique

Presentation FAQ

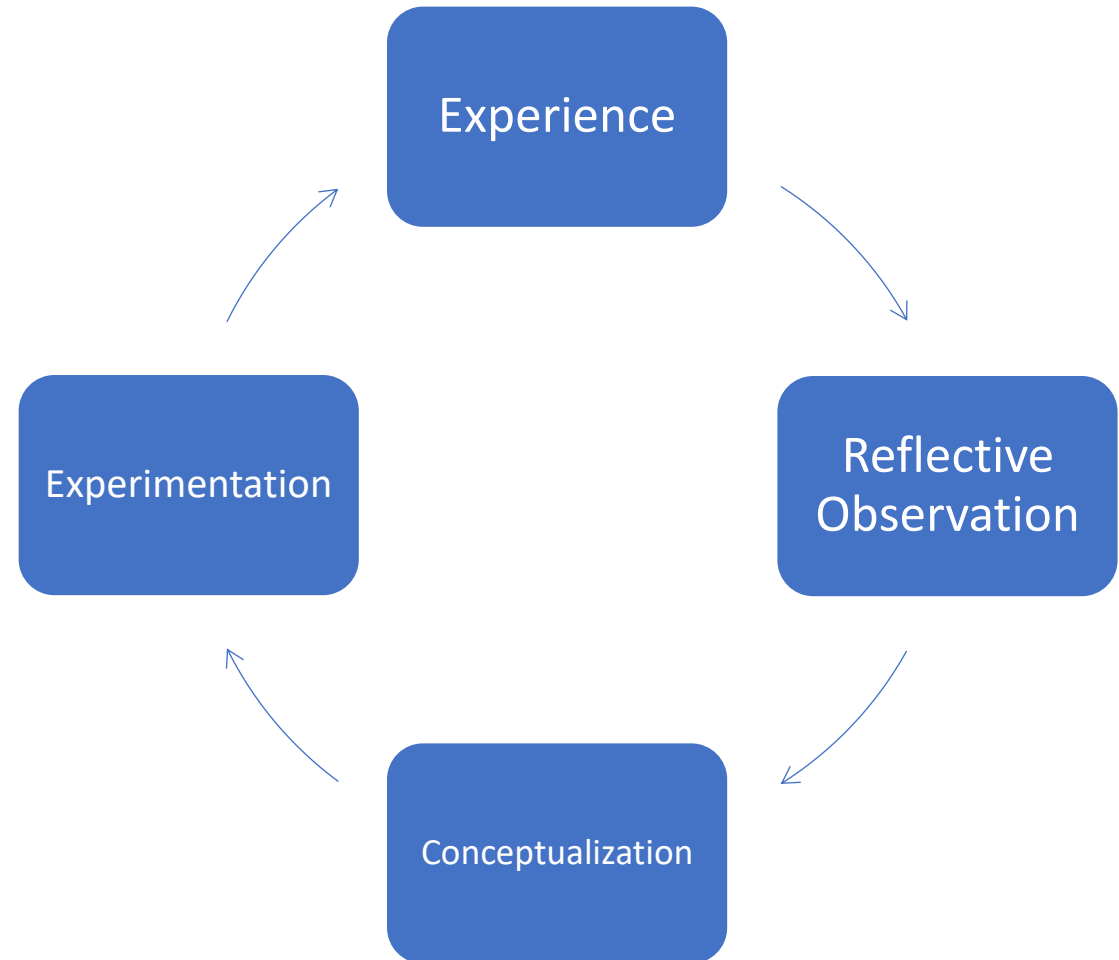
- Presentations are next Tuesday
- Presentations will be 5 minutes per team + questions
 - Not everyone needs to speak!
- Presentations are a type of report – everything from yesterday's lecture applies
- Your audience is in the feedback from assignment #1
- There will be a Canvas quiz reflecting on the Q&A sessions

Why Critique is Necessary

- Improves quality of work
 - More feedback means more chances to improve
- Encourages collaboration
 - Providing feedback creates a level of shared responsibility
- Prevents blind spots
 - Highlights issues of biases that might be overlooked
- Fosters accountability
 - Forces you to justify and explain your reasoning

Kolb's Learning Cycle

- Experimentation
 - Do something and produce some results
- Reflective Observation
 - See how it went (*critique comes here*)
- Conceptualization
 - Draw new concepts and implications from the observation
- Experimentation
 - Plan the next activity with this knowledge



The Psychology of Critique

- Emotional reactions
 - Critique can feel personal, especially when you worked hard on something
 - It's easy to get defensive when facing negative feedback
- Cognitive biases
 - Confirmation bias – tendency to favour information that aligns with your existing beliefs
 - Negativity bias – negative feedback tends to feel more impactful than positive
- Conflict avoidance
 - Some people won't want to give critique to prevent tension
 - Cultural norms differ in what is acceptable and critique and how it's given
- Power dynamics
 - Critique can be received differently depending on who it comes from

The Feedback Framework

- Start positive
- Be specific
 - Focus on individual components and not overall opinions
 - Give actionable insights
- Focus on impact
 - What positive outcome will come from your critique?
- Be collaborative
- End positive

Receiving Feedback

- Listen (but actually listen)
 - Stay focused on what the other person is saying
 - Don't interrupt to defend yourself
- Ask for clarification
 - If the feedback is vague, ask for specific examples or further explanation
- Evaluate the feedback
 - Not all feedback needs to be implemented!
 - Get additional inputs if you're not sure
- Keep a growth mindset
 - Critique is a tool for improving and learning
 - Critique is not a judgement of your ability

Implementing Feedback

- Categorize general feedback vs. actionable feedback
 - General feedback – “this visualization could be better”
 - Actionable feedback – “it is hard to distinguish different sets in this figure”
- Prioritize feedback to implement
 - Impact vs. effort
- Communicate progress
 - Share updates with people who provided feedback

Practice Activity

In pairs (or groups of 3) – that are **not** part of your assignment group – share a part of your analysis you would like feedback on. This can be a *method*, a *visualization*, an *interpretation*, or anything else you've worked on.

Have the other person/people offer critique of this piece of work.

For the Canvas quiz, provide:

- A description of what you presented
- What feedback you received
- One action you will take as a result of this feedback